

Algorithms as Recipes

Project: Helpful Classroom Sorter

1. Algorithms as Recipes

Teach the learning cycle

Primary target: Trace an ordered algorithm using the current value after every instruction

Session · Sequence and minutes · Resources

Session: Session 1 · Understand · 45 min

Sequence and minutes: 0–7: recall and prerequisite; 7–15: inspect the concrete case and predict; 15–30: teacher models the worked trace; 30–40: learners explain a step using the text and visual; 40–45: check the core idea.

Resources: Sections 1–6; record the brief recall in the workbook.

Session: Session 2 · Practise · 45 min

Sequence and minutes: 0–5: retrieve the procedure; 5–15: W2 completion practice; 15–23: explain and check with a partner; 23–30: each learner answers the misconception check; 30–40: targeted reteaching or a harder variation; 40–45: prepare the investigation.

Resources: Sections 7–10; use the matching workbook W2 and misconception check.

Session: Session 3 · Investigate and transfer · 45 min

Sequence and minutes: 0–5: retrieve the decision rule; 5–20: investigate or trace; 20–30: start the independent case; 30–38: connect the project; 38–43: act on feedback; 43–45: plan the return check.

Resources: Sections 9 and 11–14. Give extra time to finish the full task set; use Section 15 when the week includes a coding lab.

This is a starting allocation of 135 minutes, not a validated duration. Preserve all named topics. Schedule extra time for connected examples, the full investigation, independent cases and project building. Repeated copies of a case share one recorded attempt; they are not new evidence.

Retrieval answer guidance

Features: Useful Clues

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Features: Useful Clues. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Choose recorded properties that preserve distinctions needed for a stated task

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Use length and width measured before the decision. State the order as length in cm, then width in cm; the record is 12, 8. The target is fits or too large under the guide, and this card is fits because both equalities are included. Colour and card number are not needed for this rule; the final inspection sticker copies the answer and is unavailable before inspection.

Sound Becomes a Signal

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Sound Becomes a Signal. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Interpret an ordered sequence of sound-signal samples with a stated time interval

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Five samples, a 2 ms interval, and 8 ms from first to last. Consecutive pairs make gaps 0-2, 2-4, 4-6 and 6-8: four gaps between five samples.

Sensors Are Messengers

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Sensors Are Messengers. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

Look for: Describe a measurement using its quantity, value, unit and conditions

Reference example, not the only acceptable wording: Keep the observed value 24 and approximate time lunchtime; mark the unit, exact time if needed, location, exposure and device identity as unknown or to be checked. A suitable completed record needs air temperature, value, unit and relevant conditions. Invented degrees C or shade is not an observation.

Use the student module and workbook section with this exact week title. The worked case, independent question and answers below form one aligned lesson sequence.

What the learner must demonstrate

On numbered squares 0–5, start at 1 facing increasing numbers. Execute FORWARD 2, TURN, FORWARD 1, STOP. Define TURN as reversing direction. Trace position and direction after every instruction. What if TURN were unspecified?

Concept to explain

An algorithm is an ordered, testable procedure, with or without code.

Term · Meaning

Term: algorithm

Meaning: ordered procedure for a task

Term: step

Meaning: one executable action

Term: sequence

Meaning: the order in which steps run

Term: assumption

Meaning: condition taken for granted

Prepare the class

Use the supplied scenario, student illustrations and blank paper. For numeric work, offer counters or a calculator after learners show the setup. Fictional records are supplied; personal data and paid accounts are unnecessary.

Allow 80 minutes: recall 8; explanation 12; worked demonstration 15; guided practice 20; independent assessment 15; project and reflection 10. Extend the lab into a second session when needed.

Preparation for the connected explanation

This week develops precise sequential execution with small whole-number values. An algorithm is a procedure; state consists of the current values being tracked. Make the transition from one variable to two explicit. Copying in these exercises means copying a number value, not linking boxes. Avoid presenting this as a claim about every programming-language object model. No software accounts are required, and a fixed arithmetic procedure is not evidence of learning from data.

Readiness answer

The selected record hides width, which this task needs. Identical length-only inputs can require different labels. We must retain the relevant information instead of expecting a later process to recover it with certainty.

An erasable box labelled Score and instruction cards for add, double, subtract, set, report and stop

Two erasable boxes labelled X and Y, and paper traces with Stage, X and Y columns

The independent W4 task on a separate sheet; counters may support addition before students trace without them

End goal for the pictorial case

By the end, I can trace changing state and explain why instruction order matters.

This added worked case illustrates the week's main idea. Retain all original and connected topics; schedule its practice within the teaching cycle.

2. Explain the mechanism

Explain the mechanism

Follow the information instead of imagining magic inside the machine.

INPUT goal, starting state, and available objects

PROCESS follow ordered unambiguous steps

OUTPUT completed task or a visible failure point

CORE IDEA An algorithm is an ordered, testable procedure, with or without code.

UNDER THE HOOD An algorithm is a finite procedure whose steps and control flow can be executed. Correctness depends on assumptions, preconditions, order, and termination. Code is one representation of an algorithm, not the definition itself.

Draw a fresh example with all three stages:

Every step connects a claim to observable evidence.

CASE A paper robot cannot infer missing intentions; it needs ordered steps that another person can execute and test.

STEP 1 — OBSERVE goal, starting state, and available objects

STEP 2 — TRACE follow ordered unambiguous steps

STEP 3 — CONCLUDE completed task or a visible failure point

MODEL REASONING A strong algorithm states the starting arrangement, names each object, orders actions, and includes checks such as whether the bag is open. The revision targets the failed assumption rather than replacing every step.

DO NOT OVERCLAIM A goal is not yet an algorithm; each step must tell the actor what to do.

What new evidence could change this answer?

Concrete teaching case

A robot starts on the left of three squares, facing right. It executes MOVE, MOVE, STOP, each MOVE being one square.

Trace the position after each command.

Exact explanation to model

Middle, rightmost, unchanged. Direction, distance and starting conditions must be specified.

Explain the added worked example

A classroom score display starts with the number 4. Its instructions are: add 3 to score; double score; subtract 2 from score; report score and stop. What number should it report? Before doing the arithmetic, name the value being tracked and write its starting value. Here the variable is score and the initial state is score 4.

An algorithm gives precise instructions for a task. In this chapter each instruction is carried out once, in the written order. An update replaces the current value. After adding 3, score is 7. The next instruction therefore doubles 7, not the original 4. Keeping only the starting value in mind is a common source of errors.

A variable name stays the same while its value may change. Think of score as the label on an erasable number box. Updating the box does not keep all earlier numbers inside it. A separate trace preserves those earlier states so we can explain how the result was reached. This score procedure follows fixed arithmetic instructions; it does not learn from examples.

Write the initial state first. For each instruction, read the latest value, perform the operation, and record the new state. A transition is the change from one recorded state to the next.

In words, double score means calculate twice its current value and store that result in score. Add 3 to score means increase the current value by 3. Set score to 3 means replace it with 3 instead. These instructions sound similar but do different things: if score is 7, adding 3 produces 10, while setting it to 3 produces 3.

A trace is evidence of one execution from one initial state. To compare two procedures fairly, keep the initial state the same and list every intermediate value. Then you can point to the first difference instead of only comparing the final numbers.

Key terms

Term · Meaning

Term: Algorithm

Meaning: A precise procedure for carrying out a task

Term: Variable

Meaning: A named place for a value that can be updated

Term: State

Meaning: The current values being tracked at a particular point in a process

Term: Initial state

Meaning: The values before the first instruction is carried out

Term: Trace

Meaning: A record of the state as instructions are carried out in order

Model the reasoning aloud

Use the complete worked example below before asking learners to complete W2. Reveal a small part, invite a prediction, then explain the deciding step. These teacher notes contain solutions; do not reveal the independent case answer during modelling.

After first instruction · Add 3 gives 7 · Double gives 8

After first instruction: After second instruction

Add 3 gives 7: Double gives 14

Double gives 8: Add 3 gives 11

After first instruction: After subtracting 2

Add 3 gives 7: Report 12

Double gives 8: Report 9

Both procedures use add 3, double and subtract 2, but the first two operations are exchanged. Doubling after the addition also doubles the extra 3. Adding afterward does not. The final difference comes from the order, even though both procedures started at 4.

Now use two number boxes: A starts at 2 and B starts at 0. Copy the current value of A into B, then add 5 to A. After the copy, A is 2 and B is 2. After the addition, A is 7 and B remains 2. Copying stores the value at that moment; it does not create a lasting connection between these number boxes. Record both values after each instruction, including the one that did not change.

Thinking move · Teacher prompt

Thinking move: Plan

Teacher prompt: What is given? What is the question? Which procedure fits these facts?

Thinking move: Do

Teacher prompt: Point to each input and intermediate step in the worked trace. Name the rule that allows the next step.

Thinking move: Check

Teacher prompt: Does the output answer the question? Which assumption or limitation prevents a larger claim?

Use the diagram and verbal explanation together. Ask learners to match a sentence to a specific visual step; do not assign learners fixed visual or auditory learning styles.

A pictorial worked case: Algorithms as Recipes

A fictional paper badge machine transforms an initial score using an ordered recipe.

The facts we will use

Start score=3. Recipe A: double, add 4, subtract 1, report.

Recipe B swaps the first two operations but keeps the same starting score.

AI ACADEMY / AI-1/9

Changing instruction order

	Start	After step 1	After step 2	Report
Recipe A	3	6	10	9
Recipe B	3	7	14	13

Read a cell using both its row and column labels.

Algorithms as Recipes

Start with the supplied facts

Follow each arrow. Ask which fact allows the next step.



1. Start

Both runs begin at 3.



2. Recipe A

3 → 6 after doubling → 10 after adding 4 → 9 after subtracting 1.



3. Recipe B

3 → 7 after adding 4 → 14 after doubling → 13 after subtracting 1.



4. Compare outputs

Same operations, different order: outputs 9 and 13.

CHANGE ONE THING

Change the starting score to 0 for both recipes.

Explain the changed result using the matching lesson.

Read the picture one step at a time

Step · What happens and why

Step: 1. Start

What happens and why: Both runs begin at 3.

Step: 2. Recipe A

What happens and why: 3 → 6 after doubling → 10 after adding 4 → 9 after subtracting 1.

Step: 3. Recipe B

What happens and why: $3 \rightarrow 7$ after adding 4 $\rightarrow 14$ after doubling $\rightarrow 13$ after subtracting 1.

Step: 4. Compare outputs

What happens and why: Same operations, different order: outputs 9 and 13.

Match each pictured step to the supplied facts. This is a worked teaching case, not an independent assessment.

Why this result follows

Every instruction reads the current score, not the original one unless explicitly told to. In B, doubling also doubles the added 4. In A, the extra 4 is added after doubling. The final difference of 4 follows from that order, not from different starting data.

What this example does not establish

One traced input checks one run; it does not establish every recipe is equivalent or validate an entire program.

Change one thing in the pictured case

Change: Change the starting score to 0 for both recipes.

Prediction: A reports 3 and B reports 7.

Reason: A: $0 \rightarrow 0 \rightarrow 4 \rightarrow 3$. B: $0 \rightarrow 4 \rightarrow 8 \rightarrow 7$.

Ask while showing the picture

Cover the result. Ask learners to name the inputs and predict the next step. Uncover one step, connect the icon to the actual procedure, and explain its evidence. Then change the supplied condition and compare. The picture is a representation; it does not document execution of a real AI model.

3. Demonstrate and guide practice

Demonstrate and guide practice

Board sequence

Write the given facts: A robot starts on the left of three squares, facing right. It executes MOVE, MOVE, STOP, each MOVE being one square.

Write the question to explain: Trace the position after each command.

Reveal after predictions: Middle, rightmost, unchanged. Direction, distance and starting conditions must be

specified.

Keep for an independent attempt: Instructions say pick up a pencil, write your name, then find paper. Find the first ordering problem and rewrite the three steps so another learner can follow them.

Classroom dialogue

Ask: Which facts are given, and which would we have to assume? Learners mark relevant details before discussing answers.

Say: Predict first. Show the rule, information path or calculation that would produce the result. A correct guess is not yet an explanation.

Reveal reasoning one step at a time. Explain why a tempting alternative fails. Write units and denominators for arithmetic, trace conditions for decisions, and identify supporting sources for claims.

In pairs, one learner solves while the other checks evidence; exchange roles. Remove the worked answer before independent assessment.

Model these guided questions

The guided trace is 5,7,14,13. Double reads 7 because the add-2 instruction has already replaced 5 with 7. For the exit response, compare the initial states and the meaning/order of the instructions, then compare successive recorded states. Different starts can give different correct results. With matching starts and instructions, the first differing transition identifies where to inspect the calculation or interpretation.

Case-specific teaching sequence

Stage · Teacher action

Stage: Session 1 start 0 to 7 minutes

Teacher action: Recall why a record must retain relevant information. Introduce score as a named box and write the initial value before the first update.

Stage: 7 to 20 minutes

Teacher action: Model score 4 through add 3, double and subtract 2. Erase and replace the current value while retaining every old value in a separate trace.

Stage: 20 to 33 minutes

Teacher action: Compare the reordered procedure from the same initial 4. Contrast set score to 3 with add 3 to score using a current value of 7.

Stage: 33 to 45 minutes

Teacher action: Students complete W1 and W2. Ask them to identify the value each instruction reads, not just announce the final result.

Stage: Session 2 start 0 to 8 minutes

Teacher action: Model the A and B copy example: 2,0 becomes 2,2 then 7,2. Record unchanged values as well as updated ones.

Stage: 8 to 23 minutes

Teacher action: Use W3 and the guided response to identify the first incorrect transition. Require later states to be recomputed from the repaired value.

Stage: 23 to 38 minutes

Teacher action: Collect W4 independently. Learners trace both instruction orders from the same start and explain why copying a number is not a lasting link.

Stage: 38 to 45 minutes

Teacher action: Discuss W5 and the exit response. Show why an intermediate trace can distinguish procedures whose final values happen to match. Preview conditional instructions.

Reduce help deliberately

Completion task: Two procedures start score at 6. Procedure A sets score to 4, then adds 2. Procedure B adds 4 to score, then adds 2. Trace both and explain why the first instructions are different.

Teacher check: A traces 6, 4, 6. B traces 6, 10, 12. Setting replaces the current value with 4; adding increases the current 6 by 4. The procedures therefore have different intermediate and final states.

Start by identifying the given inputs together. Leave the intermediate steps blank. If needed, model one step, then withdraw that help on the next step. Move to a full trace only when the partial trace is understood. For partners, alternate explainer and checker; collect a response from every learner before discussion.

Individual reasoning check

Use the worked case for Algorithms and changing state. Proposed explanation: “Every instruction uses the original number”. Decide whether this explanation is supported. Point to the step or supplied fact that decides; explain your repair if needed.

Expected correction: Point to the most recent trace entry. Double after add reads the updated number, not the initial one.

Collect explanations, not only yes/no votes. If a misunderstanding is common, re-model the relevant step for the class. If it affects a few learners, give a short targeted group explanation while others solve a more demanding variation.

Pictorial practice question

Use the arrows to explain where the two zero-start runs first differ.

Reasoned teacher answer

They first differ after operation one: A has 0 and B has 4. Their reports are 3 and 7.

Changed-case reasoning: A reports 3 and B reports 7. A: $0 \rightarrow 0 \rightarrow 4 \rightarrow 3$. B: $0 \rightarrow 4 \rightarrow 8 \rightarrow 7$.

Collect each learner's explanation before discussion. Use the first missing connection between input, deciding step and result to choose support. This question is worked-case practice, not fresh mastery evidence.

4. Run the weekly evidence lab

Run the weekly evidence lab

Predict first, test honestly, and explain what the evidence means.

State your prediction before the result is known.

Complete the task: Write directions for a paper robot to pack a bag.

Keep a normal case and an edge case clearly separated.

Record what happened—even when it does not match your prediction.

Explain the result, one limitation, and the next useful test.

INDEPENDENCE After support is removed, repeat the proof with a fresh case.

Make the lab runnable

Use the concrete case as the shared normal case and the independent question as a second case. Each pair creates a boundary or missing-information case and predicts its result before testing. Keep the expected result separate from an observed mistake.

Record · What to capture

Record: Input or evidence

What to capture: Exact data, instruction or claim

Record: Expected result

What to capture: Answer or safe fallback declared before the run

Record: Observed result

What to capture: Actual result, including errors

Record: Explanation

What to capture: Rule, calculation or evidence explaining the outcome

Record: Next test

What to capture: One justified change and a new prediction

Diagnose and reteach

CLAIM TO REPAIR Correct actions always work in any order.

For guessing, return to given facts and request a trace. For vocabulary without application, use one example and one non-example. For arithmetic errors, check the setup before the calculation. Finish with a different uncoached case before recording mastery.

Address these additional misconceptions

Every instruction uses the original number: Point to the most recent trace entry. Double after add reads the updated number, not the initial one.

Set and add mean the same thing: Start at 6: setting to 4 gives 4 while adding 4 gives 10. Ask which value remains in the box.

Copying keeps number boxes linked: Copy A 2 into B, then change only A to 7. B still contains the copied number 2.

A matching final value proves the whole process: Compare 10,12,10 with 10,14,10. The final values match but the steps do not.

Match the support to the first error

What the response shows · Next teaching action

What the response shows: Missing or misread facts

Next teaching action: Read the case aloud, mark supplied versus unknown facts, and let the learner restate it.

What the response shows: Wrong procedure

Next teaching action: Return to the deciding step in the worked case. Contrast it with the proposed incorrect explanation.

What the response shows: Arithmetic or implementation error

Next teaching action: Trace intermediate values or lines; preserve the first mismatch and retry that step.

What the response shows: Correct result without a reason

Next teaching action: Ask for a trace and a changed case before marking independent understanding.

What the response shows: An unsupported wider claim

Next teaching action: Ask which supplied evidence supports the claim and which further observation would be needed.

Offer an oral explanation, drawing, enlarged visual or fewer examples when that removes a reading/writing barrier. Keep the same reasoning goal. Stretch secure learners by changing a boundary or assumption and asking them to defend the effect, not simply by assigning more of the same questions.

5. Assess and explain the answers

Assess and explain the answers

Worked case answer

Middle, rightmost, unchanged. Direction, distance and starting conditions must be specified.

Independent question

Instructions say pick up a pencil, write your name, then find paper. Find the first ordering problem and rewrite the three steps so another learner can follow them.

Expected independent answer

Find paper before writing. One valid order is find paper, pick up a pencil, write your name on the paper. Instructions must supply needed materials before the action that uses them.

What counts as evidence

Criterion · 0 points · 1 point · 2 points

Criterion: Result

0 points: Incorrect or absent

1 point: Partly correct

2 points: Correct with necessary conditions

Criterion: Reasoning

0 points: No supporting trace

1 point: Some steps

2 points: Clear mechanism, calculation or source support

Criterion: Limit

0 points: Overclaims certainty

1 point: Vague limitation

2 points: Relevant uncertainty or missing fact

Criterion: Transfer

0 points: Copies without adapting

1 point: Adapts with prompts

2 points: Solves a changed case independently

Use 6/8 as a classroom checkpoint, with 2 required for both Result and Reasoning. This is a proposed teaching rule, not a validated certification threshold. Do not count a coached answer as independent mastery; correct unsafe or unsupported claims regardless of total.

Feedback

Ask the learner to find the evidence that challenges this claim: “Correct actions always work in any order.” Keep the first attempt and an uncoached retry separate.

Original transfer answer

Positions are 1 initially, then 3, 3, 2, 2. Direction changes from increasing to decreasing at TURN. Without TURN's meaning the later position is ambiguous; an algorithm requires enough detail for another person to

reproduce it.

Explanations for the additional workbook examples

W1 Trace the current value

Start score at 3. Add 4 to score, double score, then subtract 5. Record the initial state and the state after each instruction. Underline the number used by the doubling step and explain where it came from.

The trace is 3, 7, 14, 9. The doubling step uses 7, the current value after adding 4 to 3. It must not double the initial 3. Accept a table, arrows or clearly labelled sentences that preserve the order.

W2 Distinguish replacement from addition

Two procedures start score at 6. Procedure A sets score to 4, then adds 2. Procedure B adds 4 to score, then adds 2. Trace both and explain why the first instructions are different.

A traces 6, 4, 6. B traces 6, 10, 12. Setting replaces the current value with 4; adding increases the current 6 by 4. The procedures therefore have different intermediate and final states.

W3 Repair the first error

A procedure starts score at 6, adds 2, doubles score, then subtracts 3. A trace says 6, 8, 12, 9. Identify the first wrong transition, explain the likely mistake and write a complete corrected trace. Why is changing only the last value inadequate?

The transition from 8 to 12 is the first error. It appears to double the initial 6 instead of the current 8. The correct trace is 6, 8, 16, 13. Changing only the last value leaves the incorrect update unexplained and does not show a valid execution.

W4 Trace two changing number boxes

For a new display, X starts at 4 and Y starts at 1. Copy the current X into Y; add 3 to X; double Y; report both and stop. Record X and Y initially and after each instruction. Explain why Y does not become 7 when X changes. Then swap the first two instructions and trace the new procedure from the same initial state.

Original trace in X,Y order: 4,1 then 4,4 then 7,4 then 7,8. Reporting leaves 7,8 unchanged. Copying captured X as 4; it did not link Y to later changes in X. With the first two instructions swapped: 4,1 then 7,1 then 7,7 then 7,14. The changed order makes the copy capture 7 instead of 4.

W5 Test what a final answer can prove

The required procedure starts score at 10, adds 2 and subtracts 2. A learner instead adds 4 and subtracts 4. Both report 10. Write both traces and explain whether matching the final result proves that the learner followed the required procedure.

Required trace: 10,12,10. Learner trace: 10,14,10. Matching the final value does not prove the required procedure was followed; the intermediate states and instructions differ. Inspecting the trace reveals the discrepancy even though the final result matches.

Assess independent transfer

Selected case: For a new display, X starts at 4 and Y starts at 1. Copy the current X into Y; add 3 to X; double Y; report both and stop. Record X and Y initially and after each instruction. Explain why Y does not become 7 when X changes. Then swap the first two instructions and trace the new procedure from the same initial state.

Selected case answer

Original trace in X,Y order: 4,1 then 4,4 then 7,4 then 7,8. Reporting leaves 7,8 unchanged. Copying captured X as 4; it did not link Y to later changes in X. With the first two instructions swapped: 4,1 then 7,1 then 7,7 then 7,14. The changed order makes the copy capture 7 instead of 4.

Dimension · Evidence required

Dimension: Explanation

Evidence required: Names the applicable idea or procedure and ties it to the supplied facts.

Dimension: Trace and result

Evidence required: Preserves the given inputs and shows the relevant intermediate steps; distinguishes a prediction from an observed execution.

Dimension: Limits

Evidence required: States the assumptions, missing evidence or conditions under which the result would change.

Record each dimension as not yet, with support, or independent. Accept a valid alternative procedure with a defensible trace. Do not penalise an honestly recorded model failure if the learner correctly explains its evidence and limits.

Feedback that the learner uses

Name the earliest unsupported step and give one action to repair it. Have the learner make that repair now and explain why. Then assess the relevant skill on a fresh, fully specified case. Confirm it was not previously practised with feedback; solve and check the new case before assigning it. A follow-up design prompt is a starting brief, not automatically an equivalent test.

6. Connect and extend learning

Connect and extend learning

Helpful Classroom Sorter

Write the first executable sorting algorithm for one easy item before adding branches or AI.

Keep the decision, input, result, explanation and remaining limitation in the project evidence record.

Retrieve this record next week rather than restarting the project.

Support and stretch

Use physical cards, spoken explanations and a three-stage drawing. Read aloud without giving the answer. Stretch: compare two mechanisms with the same visible output and explain what evidence distinguishes them.

Exit reflection

Ask for one decision the learner can now justify and one situation requiring more evidence or human review. Confidence ratings are separate from correct independent performance.

Bridge to the next week

Next: Week 10: If/Then Decisions. Retrieve today's evidence and identify what carries forward and what is new.

Support and fresh reassessment

Use a finger or token to mark the current instruction and provide a blank trace with one row per update. Let learners verbalise Read, calculate, replace, record. Allow oral explanations alongside the table. Extension: starting at 0, compare add 2 then double with double then add 2; explain why their difference remains 2 for any starting whole number.

W4 is secure when both traces include both variables after each instruction, copying preserves the then-current value, and the swapped procedure correctly ends at X 7 and Y 14. A correct final pair without intermediate states is incomplete evidence. After support, retry from X 3 and Y 0 with copy X into Y, add 2 to X, double Y. The expected states are 3,0 then 3,3 then 5,3 then 5,6.

Week 10 adds conditions and boundary cases. Students will decide which instruction runs by testing the current state, then trace the selected update.

Plan the delayed return

Suggested return points in this level: ai-1/10, ai-1/12, ai-1/15. Use actual classroom dates, adjusting for holidays and gaps. One, three and six teaching weeks are scheduling choices, not a claimed optimal spacing.

At a delayed check, ask for the idea from memory and a changed application. Compare with the earlier independent response and record support used. For a new level, revisit the previous capstone before checking the new prerequisites.

Record · Teacher evidence

Record: Learner code and date

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Concept and case used; prior exposure

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Explanation / trace / limits

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Support and first repair

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Changed case and delayed outcome

Teacher evidence: _____

Record: Next teaching action

Teacher evidence: _____

Use the evidence to choose reteaching or the next step. A completed page, confidence rating or attractive project does not by itself demonstrate understanding.

Project evidence from this case

Write the sorter's steps in order, showing which values each step updates so a partner can reproduce the result.

7. Prepare, teach and assess

Teaching target: Trace an ordered algorithm using the current value after every instruction

Prepare the labelled worked-case picture, the matching workbook, fictional input cards and a place for individual responses. No paid AI account is required for the paper reasoning activities.

Session · Plan · Resources

Session: Session 1 · Understand · 45 min

Plan: 0–7: recall and prerequisite; 7–15: inspect the concrete case and predict; 15–30: teacher models the worked trace; 30–40: learners explain a step using the text and visual; 40–45: check the core idea.

Resources: Sections 1–6; record the brief recall in the workbook.

Session: Session 2 · Practise · 45 min

Plan: 0–5: retrieve the procedure; 5–15: W2 completion practice; 15–23: explain and check with a partner; 23–30: each learner answers the misconception check; 30–40: targeted reteaching or a harder variation; 40–45: prepare the investigation.

Resources: Sections 7–10; use the matching workbook W2 and misconception check.

Session: Session 3 · Investigate and transfer · 45 min

Plan: 0–5: retrieve the decision rule; 5–20: investigate or trace; 20–30: start the independent case; 30–38: connect the project; 38–43: act on feedback; 43–45: plan the return check.

Resources: Sections 9 and 11–14. Give extra time to finish the full task set; use Section 15 when the week includes a coding lab.

Before class, solve the supported practice: Two procedures start score at 6. Procedure A sets score to 4, then adds 2. Procedure B adds 4 to score, then adds 2. Trace both and explain why the first instructions are different.

Reasoned practice answer: A traces 6, 4, 6. B traces 6, 10, 12. Setting replaces the current value with 4; adding increases the current 6 by 4. The procedures therefore have different intermediate and final states.

Check every learner before discussion: Use the worked case for Algorithms and changing state. Proposed explanation: “Every instruction uses the original number”. Decide whether this explanation is supported. Point to the step or supplied fact that decides; explain your repair if needed.

Misconception repair: Point to the most recent trace entry. Double after add reads the updated number, not the initial one.

Support: read the exact case aloud, enlarge the labelled picture, supply input cards and model only the first deciding step. Accept a spoken explanation or drawing; retain the reasoning goal.

Extension: Change the starting score to 0 for both recipes. Require a prediction and a reason before comparing. Expected result: A reports 3 and B reports 7. Reason: A: $0 \rightarrow 0 \rightarrow 4 \rightarrow 3$. B: $0 \rightarrow 4 \rightarrow 8 \rightarrow 7$.

Independent assessment: withhold the reserved answer until the learner has attempted the new case. Record support separately from correctness.

Criterion · Not yet · With support · Independent

Criterion: Explanation

Not yet: Names an answer without a deciding fact

With support: Uses a hint to link fact and decision

Independent: Explains the deciding fact in own words

Criterion: Trace or test

Not yet: Cannot connect input and result

With support: Completes steps with prompts

Independent: Traces or tests a changed case accurately

Criterion: Limits and revision

Not yet: Claims more than evidence supports

With support: Names a limit after a prompt

Independent: States a defensible limit and useful next test

Project checkpoint: Make a transparent first version. Keep a trace of how one input becomes an output; explain the rule or learned component.

Use the weekly teacher answer for topic-specific reasoning. A saved progress tick is an activity record; judge mastery from the learner's explanation and evidence.

8. Use feedback, labs and repair paths

Use the two formative questions as supported practice, not as independent mastery scores. Discuss the deciding evidence rather than accepting a guessed selection.

The feedback comes from the reviewed public worked case. Do not reveal the separately reserved independent teacher answer until the learner has attempted that case.

Ask students to predict before running code. Preserve errors and actual outputs; collect a changed test and an explanation. The branch-boundary and indexing lessons deliberately include failure cases.

Use the earlier worked-explanation links to address a specific missing building block, then return to the current question. Adapt this suggestion after observing the learner; it is not an automatic diagnosis.

Collect the completed-work portfolio as evidence. Record support separately from correctness, and assess explanation, trace/test and limitations. Progress ticks and quiz selections alone do not establish mastery.